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Master of Management (MM)

9203 Project Management

Term: 2511

Assessment 1: Project Proposal/Charter

Topic: Serandib Supermarket – Staff Learning Management System
Project Charter

Student's Signature	N/A for digital submissions via Canvas
Submission Date	18 th May 2026
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Serandib Supermarket – Staff Learning Management System Project Proposal

PART A: Organisational Context and Project Initiation

1. Organisational Background

1.1 Goals

Serandib Supermarket aims at offering quality Sri Lankan grocery items in addition to offering good service to the customers, and also has good standards over operation. The supermarket wants to make it a reliable environment for its customers and so make the employees knowledgeable, polite and capable to operate in today's retail environment. Sharing a consistent service level, keeping employees well trained, ensuring food safety standards are met and keeping operations running efficiently is a key issue as the business grows and expands its product offerings.

The organisation strives to enhance capability by providing structured learning and development initiatives for staff to help them perform and develop (Aguinis & Kraiger, 2009). Business objectives include customer satisfaction, minimising workplace errors, improving workplace safety and adherence to food safety regulations and procedures. The company will also work toward uniform training procedures, to ensure that all employees receive the same information and guidance, irrespective of their role or experience.

Moreover, Serandib Supermarket aims to minimize the drawbacks of informal training approaches, such as uneven knowledge distribution and the performance differences of employees. The adoption of a digital Learning Management System (LMS) is expected to bring in a scalable and efficient training environment that will enable continuous improvement, employee engagement and long-term growth of the organisation (Sun & Chen, 2016). The system will also help management to keep track of employee development, training completion status, and compliance with operational policies and rules.

1.2 Structure

Serandib supermarket is a retail and food service store that is owned by a family and is based in Auckland, New Zealand. The business now operates on a fairly small scale with employees having a variety of operational duties, within various parts of the supermarket. They are responsible for customer service, inventory, maintaining the shelves, food safety, cleaning, product management, and cash handling.

The organisational structure is rather simple and centralized with important supervision and management functions carried out by the business owners and senior supervisors directly. The front line staff who have direct contact with customers and are involved in the daily running of a premises are the primary people involved in the activities of the business. Staff flexibility and multitasking are crucial to the organisation's operations, as a consequence of the small number of staff.

The communication within the organisation is mostly informal, enabling management to establish strong relationships with its employees and react quickly to operational issues. As the business expands, however, the current format calls for better systems and processes that facilitate effective staff development, training consistency and standardisation of the business throughout the supermarket.

1.3 Culture

Customer service is put first, cultural understanding is valued, there is a strong emphasis on teamwork and flexibility is a key part of the organisational culture at Serandib Supermarket. The business fosters a positive and cooperative workplace that encourages employees to support each other in delivering their everyday business operations and ensuring customer satisfaction. The organisation also prioritises cultural connections and community involvement as a grocery store in Sri Lanka, enabling them to offer familiar products and services to a wide range of customers.

The current teaching-learning approach in the organisation is very informal, wherein new members learn from the experienced members through observation and verbal instructions in the actual operation of the work (Grossman & Salas, 2011). Although this gives flexibility and helps to build some operational experience, it can also lead to a lack of consistency in the quality of training, knowledge deficits, and insufficient documentation of operational procedures.

The growing complexity of the retail trade, the diversification of products and the more stringent requirements in the field of food safety and occupational health underscore the need for more structured and formalized training culture. The use of a digital Learning Management System (LMS) will contribute to the setting of consistent training standards and support continuous training, increase the confidence of staff in the use of the LMS and boost the professionalism of the organisation (Salas et al., 2012). The system will also promote knowledge sharing, accountability and continuous staff development, as well as the long-term development and sustainability of the business.

1.4 Stakeholders (Internal and External)

Internal stakeholders include:

- Sponsor/Business Owner
- Project Manager
- Employees
- Subject Matter Experts (SMEs)
- LMS Administrator
- Content Developers

External stakeholders include:

- Customers

- Regulators and Food Safety Authorities
- Future LMS clients and sponsors
- IT support personnel

The sponsor has authority and interest in regards to project scope, budget and large decisions. Employees and Managers are the primary stakeholders as they are the stakeholders who will need to participate, engage and adopt the LMS for success.

1.5 Competition

The retail and supermarket grocery sector in NZ is a very competitive market, and businesses are constantly looking for ways to enhance customer satisfaction, efficiency and compliance with food safety regulations. The use of digital technologies, formal employee training and new management systems has become more widespread at larger supermarket stores and smaller, independent grocery stores to increase productivity, minimize operational mistakes and boost the customer experience. Retailers are expected to provide a steady level of service quality, knowledge about products, cleanliness in the store and efficient service (Yi et al., 2022).

Additionally, Serandib Supermarket is a competitor to both mainstream supermarket stores as well as to the specialised ethnic grocery stores which sell both similar products and services. Using a Learning Management System (LMS) will help the organisation to enhance the capabilities of staff, regularise working practices in the workplace, improve food safety compliance, and ensure uniformity of working practices. This will benefit the quality of customer service, and help them perform better and gain competitive edge in the expanding retail market.

2. Business Case

2.1 Problem/Opportunity Statement

Currently, Serandib Supermarket is relying on informal training techniques which involve learning by observing and doing practical work. As businesses grow, diversify products, comply with food safety standards and meet workplace safety guidelines this is proving to be increasingly ineffective.

Studies show that the use of Learning Management Systems (LMS) enhances employee knowledge, performance, service quality and safety results (Alduaij et al., 2024; Sun & Chen, 2016). Online training systems offer adaptable, budget-friendly, and measurable learning resources to aid staff development and adherence to regulations (Sun & Chen, 2016).

This project aims to develop a Learning Management System in cloud computing environment to:

- Standardise staff training.
- Enhance food safety adherence.
- Improve service to customers.
- Minimize work-related accidents and mistakes.
- Enhance staff retention of knowledge.
- Develop an industry applicable and scalable training model.

Supporting Data:

- Employees are currently predominantly being trained on the job, and informally.
- More structured training processes are needed to meet the more complex food safety and occupational health requirements.
- Research indicates that service orientation training has been effective in enhancing customer relations and service quality.
- Online learning systems offer flexible staff training, which is affordable and tracked.

2.2 Benefits Analysis

There are positive organizational benefits to be expected, such as:

- Reduction of staff time.

Justification: E-learning through Justification: Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), training videos, and quizzes will enable employees to work more independently and with less supervision to minimize operational errors and increase consistency (Salas et al., 2012).

- Minimized accidents and safety incidences.

Justification: Online health and safety training will ensure compliance to the food safety and workplace safety regulations and assist to minimize workplace incident, injury and associated costs (Barati Jozan et al., 2023; Robson et al., 2012).

- Enhanced customer service levels and satisfaction.

Justification: Developing employees' product knowledge, communication and customer service skills will provide positive customer interactions and a better customer service experience (Tusell-Rey et al., 2021; Yi et al., 2022).

- Improved compliance with the New Zealand Food Safety regulations.

Justification: Formalised procedures and structured staff training contribute to regulatory compliance and accountability for operations (New Zealand Government, 2014).

- Cost and revenue savings over the long term.

Justification: The in-house developed LMS allows for decreased dependence on other vendors and future potential for LMS solutions for other small businesses.

2.3 Cost–Benefit Analysis

Costs

Cost Item	Estimated Cost (NZD)
Hosting and LMS tools	1,500
Content creation tools	800
Video production support	1,000
Miscellaneous project costs	1,300
Total Estimated Cost	4,600

Benefits (Year 1)

Benefit Category	Estimated Benefit (NZD)
Internal operational savings	20,000
External LMS revenue	9,000
Total Estimated Benefits	29,000

$$\text{Net Gain} = 29,000 - 4,600 = 24,400$$

$$\text{ROI} = ((29,000 - 4,600) \div 4,600) \times 100 \approx 530\%$$

2.4 Letter to Sponsor

Date: 15 May 2026

Prepared by: Project Manager (Group)

Manager,
Serandib New Zealand Limited,
3/875 Dominion Road, Mount Roskill,
Auckland 1041

Dear Sir/Madam,

Project Proposal to Implement a Learning Management System

We are pleased to submit this request for approval to prepare a project proposal for Serandib New Zealand Limited as part of our Project Management module at ICL Graduate Business School, Auckland, New Zealand.

Our group consists of five students currently pursuing the Master of Management programme. This project is designed to apply our academic knowledge to a real business environment while supporting local businesses in improving their operations and customer services.

We selected Serandib New Zealand Limited because of its high-quality products and growth potential. Our project focuses on improving current commercial activities, operational processes, and staff capability.

The proposal project may include areas such as:

- Recruitment and customer handling
- Customer service improvement
- Inventory and stock management
- Digital marketing and online presence
- Staff coordination and workflow improvement
- Business process efficiency and customer experience
- Standard operating procedures

Our main objective is to support the future development of Serandib New Zealand Limited while fulfilling our academic learning outcomes. All information shared by the company will be treated with confidentiality and professionalism.

We respectfully request your permission and support to carry out this project proposal for Serandib Supermarket. Our team would be grateful for the opportunity to discuss this proposal further.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours sincerely,

Kanthiparajah Manoharan
Santhush Bandara
Asanka Amarasinghe

Prasangi Abeywickrama
Odara Weliarawa

PART B: Project Management Knowledge and Application

3. Project Objectives (SMART)

Project goals are formulated in SMART way (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Realistic and Time-bound).

The project will aim to:

- By 30th May 2026: Deploy a Learning Management System with a minimum of 5 training videos and a set of SOPs.
- Create and implement SOPs on receipt, rotation of stock, cash handling procedures, cleaning and emergency response.
- Create 5-6 short training videos on product knowledge, customer service, health and safety and cash handling.
- Ensure that 100% of current employees are trained on the LMS within two months of implementing the LMS (El Hajjar & Alkhanaizi, 2018).
- Reduce number and risk workplace safety incidents by 20% or more in 1 year (Robson et al., 2012).
- Improve customer satisfaction by 15% in 1 year.
- Be able to achieve a positive Return on Investment (ROI) within 18 months
- Develop a learning management system (LMS) model that can be tailored to at least three retail industries.
- Contact two potential future clients/sponsors for expansion opportunities for LMS.

Project success will be judged based on the following:

Completion rates

- The quality of the training content.
- The quality of the training material.
- Reduction in incidents
- Customer satisfaction improvements
- End-user feedback
- Generate revenue and ROI.

4. Project Scope

In-Scope Deliverables

- Set up a web-based LMS with secure authentication and reporting functions.
- Create SOPs for receiving goods, stock rotation, cash handling, cleaning, and emergencies.
- Develop training videos and quizzes.
- Create assessments and staff feedback surveys.
- Provide user support during implementation.
- Prepare project documentation including:
 - Project plan
 - Risk register
 - Stakeholder register
 - Change log

Out-of-Scope Items

- Purchasing new equipment
- HR policies and payroll functions
- Online customer services
- Ongoing content management after project closure

Delivery Model

The project team will internally develop the LMS without external vendors. This includes:

- SOP development
- Video design and production
- LMS configuration
- Testing and deployment

This approach reduces project costs while increasing flexibility and organisational control (DeLone & McLean, 2003).

5. Constraints

There are a number of constraints that could affect the development, deployment, and delivery of the Learning Management System (LMS). These restrictions must be properly managed to make sure the project is completed within the scope, time and resource limits provided.

Budget Constraints

The project will be conducted within a modest budget, and will utilize in-house labour resources and expertise, in preference to external consultants and development teams. Expenses will primarily be directed toward the basics, like software as a service, hosting, learning content development tools, basic technical support, etc. This will therefore require solutions and careful financial management to be cost effective and throughout the project lifecycle.

Staff Constraints

Serandib Supermarket is a small-sized company that has a relatively small number of employees who are tasked with operating the supermarket on a day-to-day basis and also carrying out work for projects like content creation, testing and training. The availability of staff could impact the rate of content development and system implementation.

Time Constraints

The implementation period for the project has to be within three months. This encompasses setup, creation of content, testing, training staff, and deployment. So, strict scheduling and effective time management will be critical to ensure there is no delay.

Scope Constraints

The project scope does not cover outreach and external training, operational procedures, compliance learning or employee development activities. To ensure focus and feasibility of the project, the following functions that support the HR system are not included: Customer Service functions, Payroll Management functions, Recruitment processes, HR policy formulation functions.

6. Project Risk Management

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Resistance to change from staff	Medium	Medium	Engage staff early, communicate benefits, provide support
Content development delays	Medium	High	Assign clear responsibilities and include schedule buffers
Technical development challenges	Medium	High	Use existing frameworks, conduct testing, provide technical support
Regulatory changes	Low	Medium	Monitor regulatory updates and update SOPs regularly
Data security breaches	Low	High	Implement secure authentication and comply with data protection requirements

7. Milestone Timeline

Milestone	Start Date	End Date
Project kick-off and sponsor approval	13 May 2026	20 May 2026
LMS selection and requirements definition	21 May 2026	04 June 2026
SOP development	21 May 2026	21 June 2026
Video script and production	21 May 2026	30 June 2026
LMS configuration and content upload	01 July 2026	15 July 2026
Pilot testing and adjustments	16 July 2026	30 July 2026
Full rollout and staff training	01 August 2026	09 August 2026
Post-implementation review and closure	10 August 2026	17 August 2026

8. Work Breakdown Structure (WBS)

Phase 1 – Project Initiation

- Sponsor approval
- Kick-off meeting
- Requirement gathering

Phase 2 – Planning

- Develop project plan
- Develop risk register
- Develop stakeholder register
- Define LMS requirements

Phase 3 – Content Development

- Create SOPs
- Develop training scripts
- Produce training videos
- Develop quizzes and assessments

Phase 4 – LMS Development and Configuration

- Configure LMS platform
- Upload training materials
- Configure reporting tools
- Conduct testing

Phase 5 – Implementation

- Pilot testing
- Staff onboarding and training
- Full deployment

Phase 6 – Closure

- Post-implementation review
- Project documentation handover
- Lessons learned documentation

9. Project Budget

Cost Item	Estimated Cost (NZD)
Hosting and LMS tools	1,500
Content creation tools	800
Video production support	1,000
Miscellaneous project costs	1,300
Total Estimated Cost	4,600

Expected Benefits

Benefit Category	Estimated Benefit (NZD)
Internal operational savings	20,000
External LMS revenue	9,000
Total Estimated Benefits	29,000

ROI Calculation

$$\text{ROI} = ((29,000 - 4,600) \div 4,600) \times 100 \approx 530\%$$

The internally developed LMS significantly reduces costs while creating opportunities for long-term scalability and external revenue generation.

PART C: Project Team Management

10. Project Team Management

10.1 Project Team Acquisition and Induction

The project team will include:

- Sponsor
- Project Manager
- Subject Matter Experts (SMEs)
- Content Developers
- LMS Administrator

Team members will be selected based on availability, technical capability, and operational knowledge. The project will begin with a formal kick-off meeting to clarify project goals, scope, schedules, and team responsibilities.

Training and induction activities will include:

- LMS platform training
- SOP writing guidelines
- Video production training
- Food safety and instructional design workshops

Continuous learning and collaboration will be encouraged through meetings, workshops, and pilot testing activities.

10.2 Assigning Responsibilities to Team Members

Team Member	Responsibilities
Sponsor	Approve scope, budget, and major decisions
Project Manager	Coordinate project activities and communication
SMEs	Develop SOPs and validate training content
Content Developers	Create videos, quizzes, and training materials
LMS Administrator	Configure and maintain the LMS platform

10.3 Decision-Making Process

The Project Manager will oversee operational and day to day decisions within the project to ensure that the project is delivered on time, within budget and to the desired level of quality. The Project Manager will coordinate project activities, monitor the performance of the project team, allocate

resources and resolve operational issues that occur during implementation. The Subject Matter Experts (SMEs), content developers and technical team will work together on technical decisions such as the functionality of the system, integration with the system, structure of the training content, and accessibility to the content to ensure accuracy, practicality and alignment with the organisational needs (Huemann et al., 2016).

Major decisions which could impact the project scope, budget allocation, resource availability, project risks, and/or project timeline will be formally communicated to the Project Sponsor for approval. This is a structured decision making process that will provide for accountability, transparency and effective governance in a project's life cycle.

10.4 Conflict Resolution Process

The project team will encourage open communication, collaboration, professionalism, and mutual respect to effectively manage and resolve conflicts within the workplace. There will be acceptance of minor disagreements or misunderstandings between members of the team that will be dealt with through a constructive dialogue, active listening and negotiation to find a mutually agreed solution. Events of significant magnitude that are likely to have an adverse effect on project outcomes, timelines and/or team relationships or project goals will be reported to the Project Sponsor for formal resolution and direction. Staff motivation and productivity will be maintained by encouraging positive team culture, team working, working together and recognition of individual efforts at all stages of the project.

Conclusion

The Learning Management System (LMS) proposed will enable Serandib Supermarket to have a structured, flexible, and scalable solution for training their employees, which will benefit the operational efficiency, food safety compliance, customer service quality, and long-term growth of the organisation. (Aguinis & Kraiger, 2009; Sun & Chen, 2016). This will allow staff to complete training modules online, take assessments and ensure everyone has a common understanding of the knowledge across all parts of the supermarket. This will help to lessen training inconsistencies, help to avoid operational mistakes and help to enhance overall staff productivity and performance.

Financial viability of the project is high as it is less costly to implement and maintain than the benefits of its ongoing operation and strategic impact. A formalised digital learning platform will help Serandib Supermarket to boost the skills of its workers, standardise the working process, ensure adherence to food handling and safety standards, and improve customer satisfaction by providing better service. (Barati Jozan et al., 2023; Yi et al., 2022).

Furthermore, the project also provides perspective on future business and commercial expansion through the creation of an LMS framework which can be adapted and customized for use within other retail establishments, hospitality companies, and service companies. This promotes ongoing innovation and organisational development of the proposed solution and enhances the long-term sustainability and potential market value.

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Appendix

These appendices provide supporting evidence of project planning, stakeholder analysis and operational design. They enhance transparency and demonstrate the practical feasibility of the proposed LMS implementation.

Appendix A: Stakeholder Register

Stakeholder	Power	Interest	Strategy
Sponsor	High	High	Manage closely
Project Manager	Medium	High	Manage closely
Employees	Medium	High	Engage & train
SMEs	Medium	Medium	Consult
Customers	Low	High	Monitor
Regulators	Medium	High	Keep satisfied
LMS Clients (future)	Medium	High	Engage early

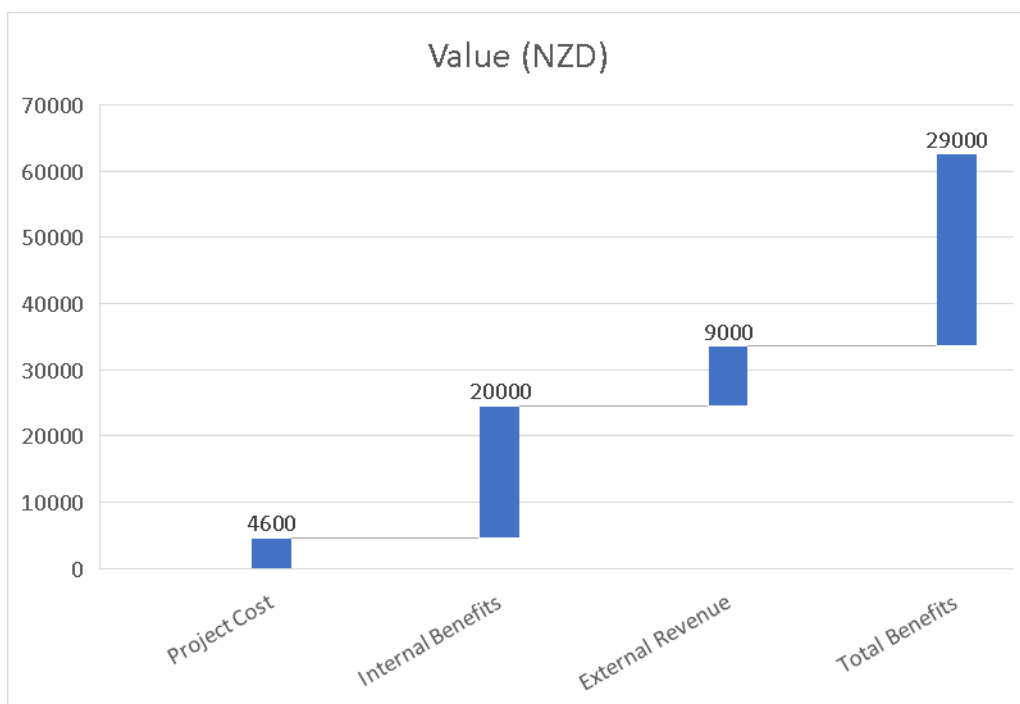
Appendix B: Gantt Chart

Task	May	Jun	Jul	Aug
Planning & approval				
LMS setup				
SOP development				
Video production				
LMS configuration				
Testing				
Deployment				
Closure				

Appendix C: ROI Graph

Category	Value (NZD)
Project Cost	4,600
Internal Benefits	20,000
External Revenue	9,000
Total Benefits	29,000

Figure 1: Comparison of total project cost and projected benefits for the LMS implementation. The internally developed LMS results in significantly lower costs and higher total benefits, producing an estimated return on investment (ROI) of approximately 530%, demonstrating strong financial and commercial viability.



The graph clearly demonstrates a substantial disparity between project cost and total benefits, indicating a highly favourable financial outcome. The internally developed LMS model eliminates vendor dependency, thereby minimizing upfront investment while maintaining high value generation. Furthermore, the inclusion of external revenue streams strengthens long-term sustainability and scalability. This financial structure positions the project not only as a cost-saving initiative but also as a commercially viable digital solution.

Appendix D: Sample SOP

Title: Cash Handling Procedure Objective: Ensure accurate and secure cash transactions Steps: 1. Log into POS system using assigned credentials 2. Verify opening cash balance 3. Process transactions accurately 4. Issue receipts for all transactions 5. Store cash securely in register 6. Reconcile cash at end of shift 7. Report discrepancies immediately Responsibility: Cashier / Store Supervisor Compliance: Must follow NZ retail and financial handling guidelines
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Appendix E: Sample Quiz

Topic: Customer Service
1. What is the first step when greeting a customer? a) Ignore b) Smile and greet ✓ c) Wait

2. How should complaints be handled?
 - a) Ignore
 - b) Escalate politely ✓
 - c) Argue
3. Why is product knowledge important?
 - a) Not important
 - b) Helps customer satisfaction ✓
 - c) Only for managers